

VINODH BALAKRISHNA

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August 5, 2025

Hiring Manager

Illumio

Sunnyvale, CA

Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm writing to express my interest in the Software Engineer – C++/Networking role at Illumio. With hands-on experience working on embedded Linux platforms, secure firmware environments, and low-level systems development in C++, I'm excited about the opportunity to contribute to your mission of redefining cyber resilience through Zero Trust segmentation.

At Comcast, I worked on the Platform Security team, where I contributed to enhancing the reliability and security of embedded Linux firmware for over a million consumer devices. My work involved building and customizing firmware using the Yocto Project, implementing features like restricted shell hardening, certificate rotation, and enabling ASLR on RDK-based platforms. I also actively participated in debugging devices over UART, integrating CI/CD pipelines, and improving internal tooling.

Outside of industry experience, I've independently developed system-level C++ projects such as a BitTorrent client leveraging memory-mapped I/O and multithreading, a custom Linux shell, and a real-time status bar using sysfs and X11. These projects reflect my drive to explore OS internals and write efficient, maintainable code at the systems layer.

I'm particularly drawn to Illumio's focus on container and cloud-native security, and while I'm still building my experience with Kubernetes, I'm eager to learn and contribute to agent design, telemetry, and multi-threaded application development.

Thank you for considering my application. I'd welcome the opportunity to connect and learn how I can best support Illumio's engineering goals.

Sincerely,

Vinodh Balakrishna